LINNAEUS'S TWO-TOED SLOTH

Choloepus didactylus

1. What can it see, hear, or feel?
Sharp hearing picks up tree movement, a keen nose finds food, and claws feel every branch firmly.

2. Where does it live — and why?
It lives high in the rainforest, hanging upside down, with green algae in its fur as camouflage.

3. How does it send messages?
It is mostly silent, but hisses when threatened, slashes with its claws, and stays still to hide.

4. What does it do when something changes?
When disturbed, it moves slowly into thicker leaves and holds still to stay out of sight.

5. How does it learn?
A young sloth clings to its mother for up to a year and learns which leaves to eat.

6. How does it have babies?
A mother has one baby while hanging upside down, and carries it everywhere she goes.

7. What are its limits?
It produces little body heat, so on the ground it is nearly helpless against predators.

8. What does this teach us?
Being slow and still is a real survival plan, not weakness — it fits the whole forest.

WHY IS THIS ANIMAL HERE?

Two-toed sloths live in the rainforests of Central and South America.

Their forests are fragmented by roads, power lines, and farms.

Sloths move so slowly they cannot cross open ground safely.

When its habitat shrinks:

- they get stranded in small patches of trees
- crossing roads and wires injures or kills many
- low numbers of young make populations slow to recover

This place is not their natural home, but it can help keep the species alive.

THINK ABOUT THIS

If moving slowly kept you safe, how would you decide when something is worth moving for?

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.

SCAN TO LEARN MORE